Module 4 workbook

Life Alignment

Now we practise. We align our lives with one universal value that everyone is looking for: peace.

Key ideas

Why peace?

In nature people say “it's so peaceful here”. The opposite of love is hate, and hating something (like Marmite) is not always bad. The opposite of peace is war, which nobody calls good. And at the end of life we say “rest in peace”.

1. Practise prolonged silence

Unless it is better to speak, stay silent. Teachers and doctors use silence to understand. Investor Kevin O'Leary calls silence a superpower: talk all the time and you miss what others are saying. At home, when one person is angry, the other stays silent.

2. Good character

Keep it simple: whenever you interact with someone, leave them in a better state than before. The Harvard study of adult development, running since 1938, found warm relationships are the biggest key to a good life, and even imperfect relationships beat none.

3. An hourly peaceful meditation

Not for an hour: every hour. Set a gentle vibrating reminder and, for a moment, come into the presence of peace. A review of 20 trials found mindfulness can reduce symptoms of depression and anxiety.

Don't fight your thoughts

If I say “don't think of elephants”, you will. The mind races, so give it a focus: the symbol of peace. If you believe in God, you can share your thoughts with God.

Homework: the Three Practices of Peace

You have downloaded peace. Now install it. Tick each practice every day you do it: reviewing yourself honestly is part of the practice.

Start date: _____

1. Prolonged silence

Only speak if it is better than staying silent.

Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
Silence																														

2. Good character

Leave people in a better position than when you met them.

Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
Character																														

3. Hourly peaceful meditation

Come into the presence of peace every hour.

Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
Meditation																														

What did I notice? Has anyone said I seem calmer?

Practise

Watch the 11 minute Peace Meditation to learn the method, then take a moment every hour.